# ONDJ 2026/27 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 September 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

**Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast**

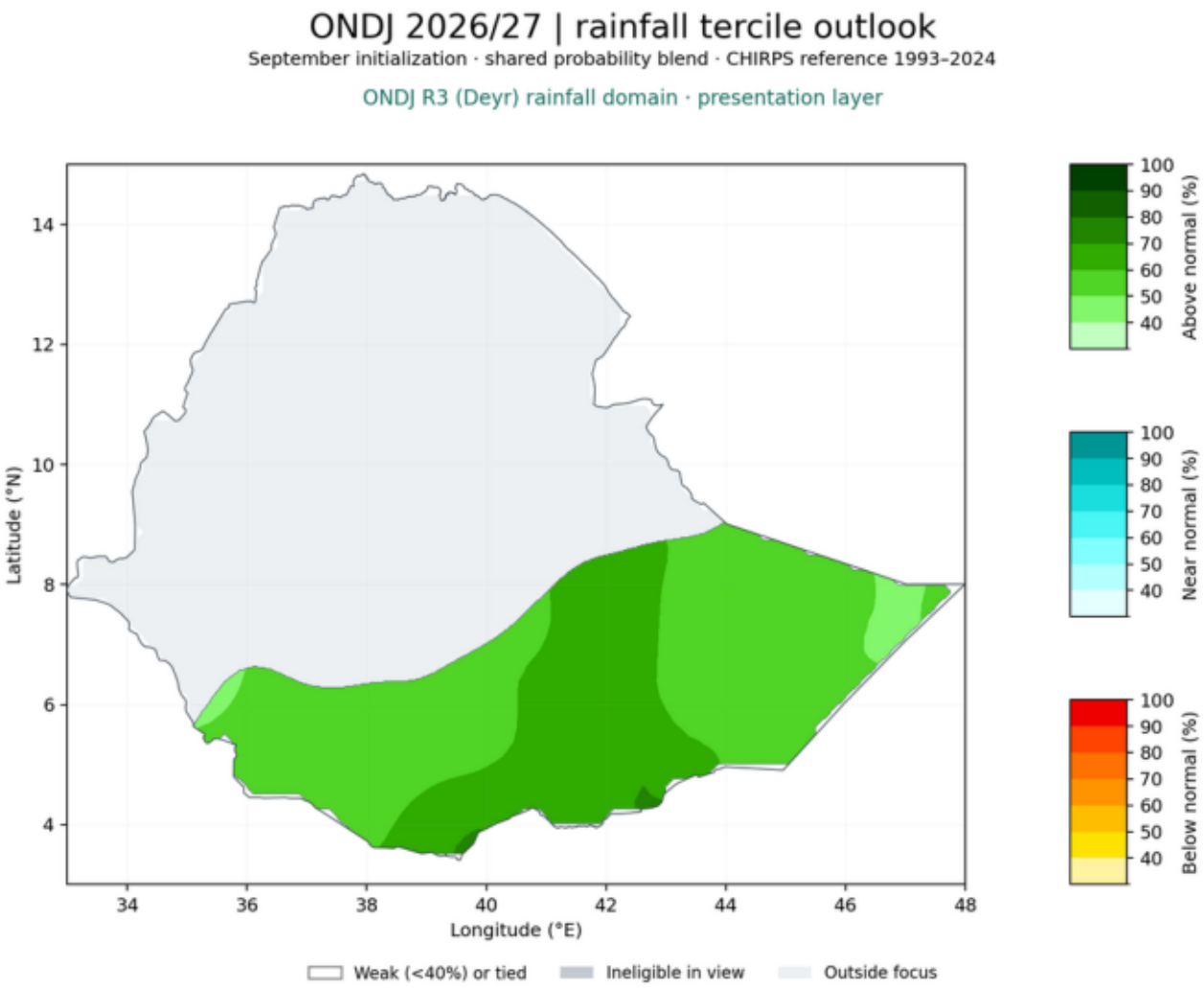
The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 58%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 265 mm against a 1993/94–2024/25 average of 188 mm (+77 mm, +41%).

**Below normal 16%** **Near normal 26%** **Above normal 58%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Strong tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain): Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero). Probability skill (RPSS) +0.133, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval +0.032 to +0.245; better than climatology in 18 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.




Display only: 12× interpolation; Gaussian σ=1.5 native cells (≈0.38°, softens the 1° model grid). Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a September-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

# All targets, evidence and record

ONDJ 2026/27 — September initialization · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

| Target | Below/near/above | Coverage | Anomaly | Verification status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ONDJ 2026/27 | 16% / 26% / 58% | 100% | +77 mm | Target period ongoing (ends 31 Jan 2027) |
| Oct 2026 | 26% / 31% / 42% | 100% | +24 mm | Target period ongoing (ends 31 Oct 2026) |
| Nov 2026 | 20% / 25% / 54% | 100% | +40 mm | Target period starts 1 Nov 2026 |
| Dec 2026 | 36% / 26% / 38% | 100% | +5 mm | Target period starts 1 Dec 2026 |
| Jan 2027 | 32% / 33% / 36% | 62% | +2 mm | Target period starts 1 Jan 2027 |

### Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

| Target | RPSS (95% interval) | Yrs better | Holm p | In words |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ONDJ | +0.133 (+0.032 to +0.245) | 18/24 | 0.040 | Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero) |
| Oct | +0.091 (+0.025 to +0.159) | 19/24 | 0.037 | Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero) |
| Nov | +0.077 (−0.030 to +0.182) | 15/24 | 0.257 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Dec | +0.002 (−0.044 to +0.051) | 9/24 | 0.799 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Jan | +0.002 (−0.013 to +0.016) | 13/24 | 0.799 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |

### Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

No target has been verified yet.

### Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 September 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Oct 2026 – 31 Jan 2027

Forecast record: Frozen 10 Oct 2026 (after the target period began, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v3.0 ONDJ 1993/94–2024/25 (32 seasons)

Observations processed through: None yet

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v3.0 monthly listing checked 13 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026

Verification last run: Not run

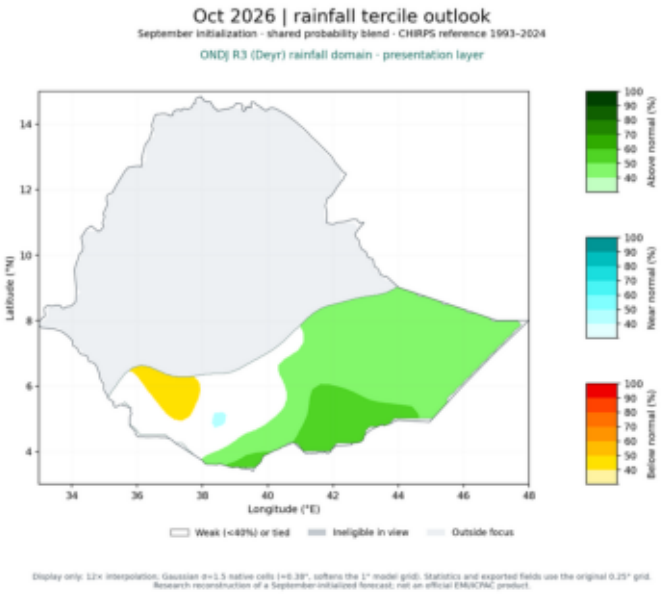
Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.18 for ONDJ) · code 6d8236d

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

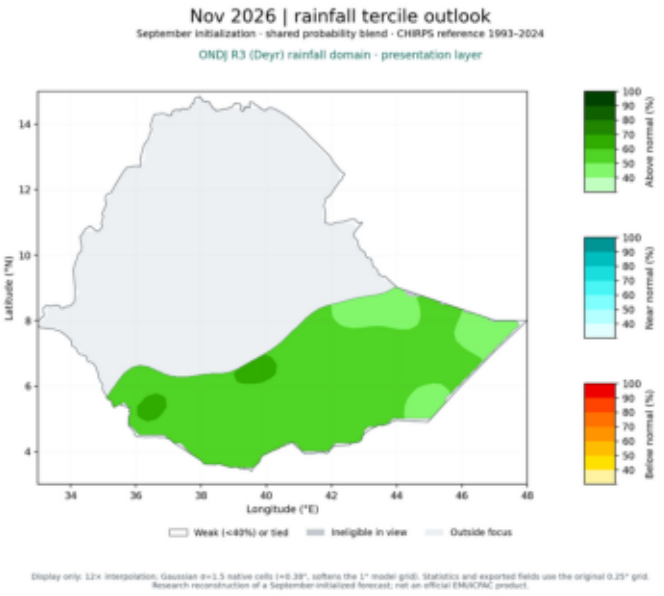
Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

# Monthly tercile outlooks

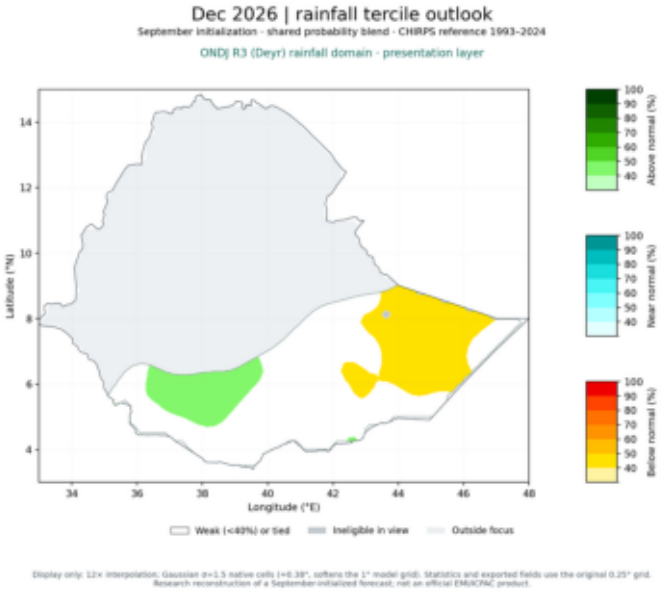
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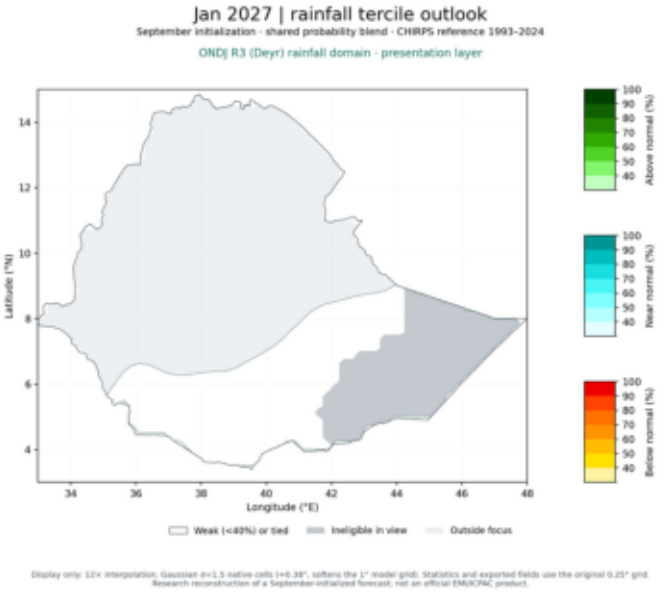

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